

ENGLISH FOR WORK / SEPTEMBER 2026

Carpentry & Remodeling English



Learner workbook

Work with realistic cases, develop your own response, and use the answer section after you have tried the tasks.

PRACTICE THAT TRANSFERS TO WORK

Read a realistic case. Study complete conversations. Find the right language, speak, get feedback, and try again.

Eight lessons | Intermediate to advanced | Independent or classroom study

For Carpenters, remodelers, finish carpenters, joinery installers, and carpentry crew leads.

Original fictional language practice, not carpentry instruction, structural assessment, legal advice, or a statement of code or permit requirements. All dimensions, incidents, quotations, products, and schedules in exercises are invented. Structural decisions, hazardous materials, tool use, installation methods, and site safety require qualified people and project-specific procedures. Sources establish occupational context, not endorsement of these cases.

All scenarios, figures, and model responses are fictional teaching material. Use invented details in practice.

[Open this course on English Ladder](#)

Your course at a glance

Use the lesson numbers to match this document with the website and the other guides.

01 Confirming openings and measurement references

Distinguish a client's usable-space requirement from a drawing dimension.

02 Selecting timber, trim, and visible finishes

Compare two finish choices without treating one feature as an overall verdict.

03 Reading details and resolving drawing conflicts

Request a specific clarification with references, location, and consequence.

04 Discussing concealed conditions without guessing

Report a concealed-condition concern without diagnosing damage or minimizing it.

05 Separating requested extras from agreed work

Discuss an extra without silently adding it to the existing price.

06 Coordinating access and other trades

Distinguish a confirmed delivery from an available work area.

07 Reviewing fit, appearance, and snagging

Repair an overstatement while agreeing a precise finish-review description.

08 Handing over records and return visits

Give the owner usable records and an identifiable follow-up contact.

Choose your pace

Quick practice: spend 15 minutes reading one conversation and rehearsing one scenario. Full lesson: allow 45-60 minutes for language work, three conversations, two speaking scenarios, and feedback.

Level support

B1 learners can use the frames and a partner. B2 learners can try a response before reading the model. C1 learners can add the harder follow-up and reduce preparation time. These are teaching suggestions, not certified CEFR level ratings.

After practicing: open the AI prompt workshop, or use the prompts at the end of this guide.

LESSON 01 / READ AND NOTICE

Confirming openings and measurement references

Distinguish a client's usable-space requirement from a drawing dimension.

SITUATION

The hall drawing labels a door opening 900 millimeters. The client assumes this is clear passage width. The note does not say rough or finished opening; no door has been ordered. The designer can clarify the reference.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

rough opening - The framed space intended to receive a door or window unit before surrounding finishes are complete.

finished opening - The opening measured between specified completed surrounding surfaces; this is not automatically the usable clear passage with a door installed and open.

jamb - A side or top member of a door or window frame.

datum - An agreed reference point or line from which project dimensions are measured.

Useful word combinations

verify the opening: confirm which opening and measurement basis are meant

measure between finished faces: state the surfaces that bound a dimension

allow for the jamb: include the frame in the dimensional discussion

establish a datum: agree the reference used for dimensions

LESSON 01 / LANGUAGE AND PRACTICE

Ask what the dimension describes

3. Notice the language

An opening dimension needs units and reference surfaces. Rough opening, finished opening, door-leaf width, and usable clear passage are different quantities. Even a finished opening measurement may not establish passage with the door and hardware present. Ask which requirement matters before discussing an order size.

Is ___ measured between ___ or ___?

When you say clear width, do you mean ___?

We have the dimension, but still need ___.

Compare this wording: The door is nine hundred, so you have nine hundred clear.

Clearer: The note says 900 millimeters; it does not establish the clear passage width.

The revision preserves the number while avoiding an unsupported promise about usable space.

4. Check the language

1. Client: I need 900 millimeters for a cabinet to pass with the door open. Which dimension matters?

Carpenter: We must confirm the ___; the finished opening alone may not establish it.

A. usable clear passage

B. rough opening

C. jamb thickness

D. door leaf width

2. Designer: What is missing from the dimension?

Carpenter: We need to know ___ measured from.

A. which reference line is it

B. which it reference line is

C. which reference line does it

D. which reference line it is

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 01 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Nine hundred between which faces?

At the hall doorway, the carpenter and client clarify the fictional 900-millimeter note.

01 • Carpenter: The hall drawing says nine hundred millimeters. Were you expecting that much clear passage?

02 • Client: Yes, our cabinet needs that space, and I thought the number guaranteed it.

03 • Carpenter: The note doesn't say whether it measures the rough opening or finished opening.

04 • Client: I hadn't realized those were different. Does the jamb take up some space?

05 • Carpenter: The frame and open door affect usable passage; we need the selected unit's dimensions.

06 • Client: We haven't chosen the door yet. Can you still clarify the drawing today?

07 • Carpenter: I can ask the designer which surfaces the number refers to before ordering.

08 • Client: Please mention the cabinet, because usable width is the requirement that matters most.

09 • Carpenter: I'll separate your passage requirement from the unresolved drawing dimension in that question.

10 • Client: That helps. Let's leave the order pending until those two things agree.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 01 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

The floor that is not finished yet

A carpenter checks a cabinet-height reference with the site coordinator.

01 • Carpenter: Your cabinet sketch gives a height, but which floor surface is the datum?

02 • Site coordinator: The finished floor should be the reference, not the exposed subfloor visible today.

03 • Carpenter: Thanks. The supplier's survey note says existing floor, which could mean something different.

04 • Site coordinator: That survey happened before the floor finish was selected. I see the problem.

05 • Carpenter: Could you confirm the current floor build-up with the designer before fabrication release?

06 • Site coordinator: Yes, and I'll ask them to identify the finished floor reference on the sketch.

07 • Carpenter: Please keep the earlier survey attached so the supplier can see what changed.

08 • Site coordinator: Should I describe the old height as wrong, or simply as needing reconciliation?

09 • Carpenter: Needing reconciliation is more accurate; the two documents may use different reference surfaces.

10 • Site coordinator: I'll request a coordinated dimension, with fabrication release still pending that response.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 01 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

A width without its units

A carpenter and supplier resolve an ambiguous shelf enquiry by telephone.

01 • Carpenter: Your quotation lists the alcove shelf as thirty, but it doesn't show units.

02 • Supplier: That's thirty inches of nominal width. Were you reading the number as centimeters?

03 • Carpenter: I was checking because our site measurements are recorded in millimeters throughout this job.

04 • Supplier: Understood. Is your figure the wall opening or the finished shelf length requested?

05 • Carpenter: It's the opening measurement; the shelf size still needs confirmation against the detail.

06 • Supplier: Then I shouldn't simply convert thirty inches and treat that as your order.

07 • Carpenter: Exactly. Please label the quotation dimension and wait for the confirmed fabrication size.

08 • Supplier: I can revise the description now without releasing any material to the workshop.

09 • Carpenter: Please also retain the unit labels when you send the revised quotation over.

10 • Supplier: Done. It will say nominal width in inches, with fabrication dimensions awaiting confirmation.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 01 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Confirming openings and measurement references

The hall drawing labels a door opening 900 millimeters. The client assumes this is clear passage width. The note does not say rough or finished opening; no door has been ordered. The designer can clarify the reference.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You are the client. You need the usable passage clarified and have not chosen a door unit.

Second round: The designer confirms a rough opening, but the client still asks whether a large cabinet will fit. Separate the two measurements.

Scenario 2 | The alcove narrows at the back

An alcove survey records front width 1,210 millimeters and rear width 1,190 millimeters. A client calls it a 1,200-millimeter opening. No shelf fabrication size is approved.

Role A: Carpenter: distinguish the two measured locations from the shorthand description.

Role B: Client: you want full-depth shelves and can show the survey sketch.

Possible opening: Is twelve hundred the front measurement, the back measurement, or a rounded description?

Success checks

- Name both locations and dimensions aloud.
- Explain why an average is not a confirmed fabrication size.
- Agree who will clarify the shelf detail before ordering.

Add a complication: The client says a single average would be simpler for the order.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

LESSON 02 / READ AND NOTICE

Selecting timber, trim, and visible finishes

Compare two finish choices without treating one feature as an overall verdict.

SITUATION

For a fictional study remodel, sample A is solid oak trim with pronounced grain and a ten-day quoted lead time. Sample B is oak-veneered trim with a more uniform appearance and a four-day quoted lead time. Both match the requested profile. No sample is selected.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

grain - The direction and visible pattern of fibers in wood.

veneer - A thin layer of wood bonded to a supporting material to provide a wood surface.

profile - The cross-sectional shape of a molding or trim piece.

finish sample - A physical example used to compare a proposed surface color, sheen, or texture.

Useful word combinations

match the existing profile: compare trim shapes, not just overall width

approve a finish sample: accept a particular reference for appearance

follow the grain: describe the visible direction of wood fibers

compare like for like: use the same dimensions and finish conditions

LESSON 02 / LANGUAGE AND PRACTICE

Compare the properties that matter

3. Notice the language

A profile is shape; grain and sheen describe different aspects of appearance. Use the same criteria for both samples. A quoted lead time is supplier information, not a promise about the entire remodeling schedule.

Both samples ___, whereas only ___.

The difference in appearance is ___.

The quoted lead time is ___; the site date remains ___.

Compare this wording: The quicker trim is better.

Clearer: The quicker option matches the profile but has a more uniform grain appearance.

The revised comparison names a tradeoff instead of declaring a universal winner.

4. Check the language

1. Client: Are the bead and curved edge the same shape on both samples?

Carpenter: Yes, they match the same ___.

- A. grain direction
- B. surface sheen
- C. veneer species
- D. profile

2. Client: How do the quoted times compare?

Carpenter: A takes ten days, ___ B is quoted at four.

- A. because
- B. despite
- C. whereas
- D. therefore

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 02 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Choosing the study trim reference

At a sample review, a carpenter and client compare the two study trim options.

- 01 • Carpenter:** Both samples match your trim profile. Which difference catches your eye in this light?
- 02 • Client:** Sample A has stronger grain. Is sample B a different shape around the edge?
- 03 • Carpenter:** No, the shape matches. B has an oak veneer and a more uniform appearance.
- 04 • Client:** I prefer A's grain, but the room is needed soon. What about delivery?
- 05 • Carpenter:** The supplier quotes ten days for A and four for B at present.
- 06 • Client:** Does choosing B mean the entire study will be finished six days earlier?
- 07 • Carpenter:** Not necessarily. Those figures concern supply; the site schedule also includes other work.
- 08 • Client:** Then keep A as my preferred sample while you check the scheduling effect.
- 09 • Carpenter:** I'll label it preferred, with the timing decision open, rather than as an order.
- 10 • Client:** Yes, show me that effect before we make the final selection for the room.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 02 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

White is not a complete finish description

A carpenter and decorator compare a trim sample with an existing painted surface.

01 • Carpenter: The client asked for white trim, but this sample looks glossier than the existing skirting.

02 • Decorator: The color reference matches. The sheen is different, which changes how light reflects.

03 • Carpenter: Could we show both together before calling this a successful finish match today?

04 • Decorator: Certainly. Is the client asking for the same color or the same overall appearance?

05 • Carpenter: Their note says match existing, so I think we need to clarify both.

06 • Decorator: I'll bring a lower-sheen sample with the same color reference for the comparison.

07 • Carpenter: Please identify the sample labels; photographs alone have made the difference hard to judge.

08 • Decorator: Agreed. We can compare them in the room under the same lighting conditions.

09 • Carpenter: Then I'll ask the client to choose a physical reference rather than another vague description.

10 • Decorator: That gives us a specific appearance target without promising every surface will look identical.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 02 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

The molding is wide enough but different

A carpenter questions a supplier's proposed replacement molding.

01 • Carpenter: The replacement molding is the right width, but the curve doesn't match our sample.

02 • Supplier: Our stock description lists the same overall dimensions. Which feature differs from yours?

03 • Carpenter: The original has a small bead at the edge; the replacement has a flat edge.

04 • Supplier: I see it now in your reference photo. So width alone isn't the issue.

05 • Carpenter: Correct. This piece sits beside retained trim, so the profile difference will be visible.

06 • Supplier: Would you like another stock sample or a quotation for a matching profile?

07 • Carpenter: Please quote the matching profile first, with its lead time shown separately from price.

08 • Supplier: I can do that. The stock alternative can remain available for the client's comparison.

09 • Carpenter: Label it alternative, please, so nobody mistakes it for an accepted substitution on delivery.

10 • Supplier: I'll update the enquiry to show profile match required, with the alternative clearly identified.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 02 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Selecting timber, trim, and visible finishes

For a fictional study remodel, sample A is solid oak trim with pronounced grain and a ten-day quoted lead time. Sample B is oak-veneered trim with a more uniform appearance and a four-day quoted lead time. Both match the requested profile. No sample is selected.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You are the client. You prefer visible grain but need to understand the supply difference.

Second round: The supplier revises A's lead time to twelve days. Recompare the options without changing the client's appearance preference.

Scenario 2 | One sample, two directions

A client approves the color of a veneered cabinet sample but says nothing about grain direction. The elevation shows horizontal grain; the sample was displayed vertically.

Role A: Carpenter: clarify whether approval covers color, direction, or both.

Role B: Client: you like the color but prefer vertical grain and have not discussed a revised elevation.

Possible opening: Does your approval cover the color only, or also the grain direction shown here?

Success checks

- Separate sample approval from drawing revision.
- State the preferred direction in ordinary words.
- Keep production confirmation pending the reconciled elevation.

Add a complication: The client assumes turning the sample also changes the production drawing.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

LESSON 03 / READ AND NOTICE

Reading details and resolving drawing conflicts

Request a specific clarification with references, location, and consequence.

SITUATION

Cabinet elevation C4 revision B shows a 20-millimeter reveal. Section S2 revision B shows 15 millimeters at the same end panel. Fabrication release is due for review at 14:00. The designer has not clarified which dimension applies.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

elevation - A drawing showing a vertical face of a room, wall, or assembly.

section detail - A drawing showing a cut-through view of an assembly and its relationships.

scribe allowance - Extra material specified so a component can be fitted to an adjoining irregular surface.

reveal - An intentionally visible strip, gap, or setback between adjoining finished components.

Useful word combinations

check the latest revision: confirm the current drawing issue

raise a drawing query: ask for clarification of a specific conflict

maintain an even reveal: describe a consistent visible spacing

reconcile the detail: obtain one consistent interpretation of conflicting information

LESSON 03 / LANGUAGE AND PRACTICE

Make a drawing question answerable

3. Notice the language

A useful query lets the designer find the conflict without guessing. Name both documents and their revisions, describe the same physical location, and ask for the intended relationship. A review deadline is not permission to choose a dimension.

On ___ revision ___, the dimension is ___ .

Could you reconcile ___ with ___?

This affects ___; please confirm ___.

Compare this wording: The cabinet drawings are confusing.

Clearer: C4 and S2, both revision B, give different reveal dimensions at the end panel.

The revised statement locates the disagreement and avoids criticizing the whole drawing set.

4. Check the language

1. Designer: Is the discrepancy on different issues?

Carpenter: No, ___ show revision B.

A. neither drawing

B. each drawing

C. both drawings

D. either drawing

2. Designer: Is the query about panel size or the intentionally visible strip between finished faces?

Carpenter: The ___ is shown as 20 millimeters on C4 and 15 on S2.

A. edge profile

B. reveal

C. scribe allowance

D. overall panel width

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 03 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Two dimensions on revision B

A carpenter calls the designer before the cabinet fabrication review.

01 • Carpenter: Could you clarify the end-panel reveal before our two o'clock fabrication review today?

02 • Designer: Which drawings disagree? I need their references and revisions to locate the issue.

03 • Carpenter: Elevation C4 shows twenty millimeters; section detail S2 shows fifteen. Both are revision B.

04 • Designer: Are those dimensions at the same end panel, or on opposite cabinet runs?

05 • Carpenter: The same panel beside the study doorway. I've marked that location on both.

06 • Designer: Thank you. I need to reconcile the detail, and I cannot answer before three.

07 • Carpenter: Then I'll keep that panel out of release at the two o'clock review.

08 • Designer: Please distinguish it from the other panels, which aren't part of this query.

09 • Carpenter: I will. Can your reply identify both the intended reveal and the drawing correction?

10 • Designer: Yes. My response will address those points, with the marked references attached for clarity.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 03 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

Extra width is not an extra shelf

A carpenter explains a supplier's scribe allowance note to a client.

01 • Carpenter: The supplier's end panel is wider on the schedule than on your finished elevation.

02 • Client: That's what worried me. Will it make the cupboard stick farther into the room?

03 • Carpenter: The schedule includes a scribe allowance, meaning extra material for fitting the adjoining surface.

04 • Client: So the scheduled piece size is not necessarily the finished visible panel width?

05 • Carpenter: Exactly. We still need the detail to confirm how that allowance is represented.

06 • Client: Please ask them, because I don't want the finished cupboard width quietly increased.

07 • Carpenter: I'll ask for separate supplied and finished dimensions on this panel's confirmation drawing.

08 • Client: Can we keep the agreed cabinet face line as the reference in that question?

09 • Carpenter: Yes, I'll name that line explicitly and attach the elevation you already approved.

10 • Client: Then the question is about interpreting the allowance, not approving a larger cupboard today.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 03 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

A cloud on the drawing

A carpenter and site coordinator identify the actual extent of a revised drawing.

01 • Carpenter: The latest elevation has a revision cloud around the upper shelves. Did the base change?

02 • Site coordinator: The issue note mentions shelf spacing only, but let's check the revision description together.

03 • Carpenter: Our earlier base detail still appears in the folder beside this new elevation.

04 • Site coordinator: That's possible; not every sheet was reissued. Which base dimension are you concerned about?

05 • Carpenter: The drawer front height. I don't see a changed dimension or a corresponding note.

06 • Site coordinator: Then we shouldn't assume the cloud changes that height merely because it's nearby.

07 • Carpenter: Could you confirm the current sheet list so the workshop uses the right combination?

08 • Site coordinator: Yes. I'll identify the reissued elevation and the retained base detail on the transmittal.

09 • Carpenter: I'll tell the workshop that shelf spacing changed, while base-height clarification remains separate.

10 • Site coordinator: Good. That prevents a partial drawing issue from being interpreted as an entirely new cabinet.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 03 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Reading details and resolving drawing conflicts

Cabinet elevation C4 revision B shows a 20-millimeter reveal. Section S2 revision B shows 15 millimeters at the same end panel. Fabrication release is due for review at 14:00. The designer has not clarified which dimension applies.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You are the designer. Ask for the two drawing references and the affected component.

Second round: You can answer only at 15:00. Agree how the panel's release status will be described at the 14:00 review.

Scenario 2 | The detail says typical

A drawing labels a 10-millimeter reveal typical. A separate pantry elevation shows a 6-millimeter reveal. Both are current; neither names an exception.

Role A: Carpenter: ask whether the pantry is an exception.

Role B: Designer: you can review the pantry relationship but cannot answer from memory.

Possible opening: Does the typical reveal apply at the pantry, or is that elevation a deliberate exception?

Success checks

- Cite both details.
- Explain that typical does not resolve a stated conflict.
- Agree the pantry item remains pending clarification.

Add a complication: The site manager wants the carpenter to choose the larger dimension for consistency.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

LESSON 04 / READ AND NOTICE

Discussing concealed conditions without guessing

Report a concealed-condition concern without diagnosing damage or minimizing it.

SITUATION

An existing exposed subfloor has dark staining beside the laundry doorway. The client asks whether the joists are rotten. The carpenter has not assessed structural condition and the joists are not visible. The project lead can arrange a qualified assessment.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

subfloor - The supporting floor layer beneath the finished floor covering.

joist - A horizontal structural member that supports a floor or ceiling.

blocking - Short framing pieces between other members, used for specified support or restraint.

concealed condition - An existing site condition that was not visible during the initial assessment.

Useful word combinations

report visible staining: describe appearance without naming a cause

identify the affected area: locate the observation precisely

separate evidence from inference: distinguish what is seen from what is assumed

request a condition assessment: ask the appropriate specialist to evaluate the finding

LESSON 04 / LANGUAGE AND PRACTICE

Describe a finding and its limits

3. Notice the language

Location, visibility, and source matter. A stain is an observation; decay and structural adequacy are conclusions requiring appropriate assessment. Keep urgent site concerns within the project's safety arrangements rather than treating this exercise as an inspection procedure.

I can see ___ at ___ .

That does not establish whether ___ .

The assessment needs to address ___ before ___.

Compare this wording: The dark patch means the joists are rotten.

Clearer: There is dark staining on the subfloor; the joist condition has not been assessed.

The revision avoids turning surface appearance into a structural conclusion.

4. Check the language

1. Client: Can you see the joists from here?

Carpenter: No, they remain ___ beneath this area.

A. directly observable

B. concealed

C. exposed

D. fully visible

2. Project lead: What does the stain prove?

Carpenter: It ___ the cause of the discoloration.

A. does not establish

B. has established

C. is caused by

D. has resulted from

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 04 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

A stain is not a joist assessment

At the laundry doorway, a carpenter answers the client's question about staining.

01 • Carpenter: There's dark staining on the exposed subfloor beside the laundry doorway in this area.

02 • Client: Does that mean the joists underneath are rotten and the whole floor needs replacing?

03 • Carpenter: I can't conclude that. The joists aren't visible, and their condition hasn't been assessed.

04 • Client: We had a washing-machine spill years ago. Could that explain what you're seeing now?

05 • Carpenter: It could be relevant history, but I can't confirm the cause from the stain.

06 • Client: Please include the spill when you speak to the project lead about the assessment.

07 • Carpenter: I will describe it as your recollection, separately from the visible staining we see.

08 • Client: Will that assessment also tell us whether any change to the agreed work is needed?

09 • Carpenter: The assessment can clarify this concealed condition before we discuss a revised carpentry scope.

10 • Client: All right. I'd rather understand the finding than approve replacement based on appearance alone.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 04 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

The photograph does not show the support

A carpenter and project lead discuss an incomplete site photograph.

01 • Carpenter: The client's photograph shows the new shelf location, but not what's behind the wall.

02 • Project lead: They're asking whether the existing blocking can support the cabinet at that position.

03 • Carpenter: We don't have a verified record of blocking there, so the photograph cannot answer.

04 • Project lead: Is there an earlier framing record we can request from the original contractor first?

05 • Carpenter: Yes, I'll ask for that record and identify which wall and cabinet position we mean.

06 • Project lead: Please don't describe the missing record as evidence that no blocking exists at all.

07 • Carpenter: Agreed. I'll say the support arrangement remains unverified, rather than absent or inadequate.

08 • Project lead: The client also wants a fixed installation date. What can we tell them today?

09 • Carpenter: We can give the current planning status and explain which assessment the date depends on.

10 • Project lead: I'll handle that conversation and keep the support question separate from our scheduling preference.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 04 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

A small gap with no agreed tolerance

A carpenter discusses a reported trim gap with the client's representative.

01 • Carpenter: You noted a gap at the stair trim. Which joint are you referring to?

02 • Client representative: The upper corner beside the landing. I photographed it this morning from the hallway.

03 • Carpenter: Thank you. Do we have an agreed sample or acceptance detail for that joint?

04 • Client representative: There's an approved detail, but I haven't compared the photograph with it yet.

05 • Carpenter: Then let's identify the location and request a comparison before calling it acceptable or defective.

06 • Client representative: The owner asked me whether every gap of that size is always a defect.

07 • Carpenter: I wouldn't give a universal answer. The detail and actual condition matter for this review.

08 • Client representative: I'll send the photograph with the drawing reference, without presenting my impression as a finding.

09 • Carpenter: Please also note the viewing location so the reviewer understands what the image shows.

10 • Client representative: Done. We'll describe it as a reported finish concern pending comparison with the agreed detail.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 04 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Discussing concealed conditions without guessing

An existing exposed subfloor has dark staining beside the laundry doorway. The client asks whether the joists are rotten. The carpenter has not assessed structural condition and the joists are not visible. The project lead can arrange a qualified assessment.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You are the client. Ask whether visible staining necessarily means structural decay.

Second round: The client remembers an old spill. Attribute that recollection without treating it as the confirmed explanation.

Scenario 2 | A ceiling mark reported after delivery

A homeowner notices a ceiling mark above the hallway-to-study doorway after cabinet delivery through that doorway. No before-photo covers the area. The route is known, but the cause of the mark is not.

Role A: Carpenter: acknowledge the concern and distinguish timing from established cause.

Role B: Homeowner: you noticed the mark at 16:00 and want it reviewed.

Possible opening: I understand why the timing concerns you; can we identify exactly where the mark is?

Success checks

- Acknowledge the concern without blaming anyone.
- State the observation time and missing evidence.
- Agree who will review the mark and report back.

Add a complication: The homeowner asks you to confirm that the delivery crew caused it.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

LESSON 05 / READ AND NOTICE

Separating requested extras from agreed work

Discuss an extra without silently adding it to the existing price.

SITUATION

The agreed bedroom scope includes replacing skirting only. The client requests a built-in bench; decorating is excluded. The carpenter can arrange a separate quotation, but no bench dimensions, price, or completion date are agreed.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

change order - A project document recording an agreed alteration to the contracted work and its stated effects.

allowance - An amount included in a project budget for a specified item whose final selection or cost is not yet settled.

exclusion - Work or supply specifically left out of an agreed scope.

making good - Repairing or restoring finishes disturbed by building work to the agreed extent and standard; called making good in some regions.

Useful word combinations

price an addition: obtain a cost for work beyond the current scope

clarify an exclusion: identify what a proposal leaves out

agree the extent of making good: define the surrounding restoration work

review the schedule impact: assess how a change affects timing

LESSON 05 / LANGUAGE AND PRACTICE

Offer a bounded choice

3. Notice the language

Name the agreed work, the requested addition, and the unanswered cost or timing questions. An allowance is not automatic approval. A request for a quotation does not authorize construction. Skirting is commonly called baseboard in U.S. usage; making good means repairing or restoring disturbed finishes.

The current scope includes ___ and excludes ___ .

We can retain ___ or request a price for ___ .

If you choose ___, we still need to agree ___.

Compare this wording: We can fit the bench in.

Clearer: We can quote the bench separately; its dimensions, price, and timing are not agreed.

The revised offer promises an assessment rather than unpriced work.

4. Check the language

1. Client: Is painting included?

Carpenter: Decorating is listed as an ___ in this proposal.

- A. exclusion
- B. allowance
- C. addition
- D. acceptance

2. Client: I haven't confirmed the dimensions yet. What happens if I request the bench?

Carpenter: If you ___ the dimensions, we can request a separate quotation.

- A. confirms
- B. confirmed yesterday
- C. are confirm
- D. confirm

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 05 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

The bench is an addition

A carpenter and bedroom client discuss the requested bench.

01 • Carpenter: The bedroom quotation covers skirting, or baseboard, replacement. The bench would be additional work.

02 • Client: I thought there might be room in the price because it's quite small.

03 • Carpenter: We haven't agreed its dimensions or storage arrangement, so I can't price it yet.

04 • Client: Could you get a separate quotation without changing the skirting work already agreed?

05 • Carpenter: Yes. We also need to clarify making good, because decorating is currently excluded.

06 • Client: I'd like a painted finish, with space underneath for two storage boxes.

07 • Carpenter: Please give us the box dimensions so that requirement is clear in the enquiry.

08 • Client: Does asking for the quotation mean I have committed to buying the bench?

09 • Carpenter: No. A change order would record any agreed alteration after you consider the price and timing.

10 • Client: Then obtain that comparison, and keep the existing bedroom scope unchanged for now.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 05 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

Painting around the new frame

A carpenter and homeowner clarify restoration around a replacement frame.

01 • Carpenter: The frame proposal mentions making good locally. What finish were you expecting?

02 • Homeowner: I assumed the whole wall would be repainted so no difference would show.

03 • Carpenter: The quotation doesn't define that extent clearly. Let's clarify it before accepting the scope.

04 • Homeowner: Can you explain the difference between local making good and decorating the wall?

05 • Carpenter: Local work concerns disturbed areas; whole-wall decoration is a broader item to price.

06 • Homeowner: Then I'd like both extents described, because appearance matters more than a vague allowance.

07 • Carpenter: I'll ask the estimator to identify the surfaces and finish standard for each option.

08 • Homeowner: Please include the return beside the doorway; it's easy to overlook from this room.

09 • Carpenter: I'll name it separately so we can see whether each quotation includes it.

10 • Homeowner: Good. We'll decide from those descriptions instead of assuming the word locally covers everything.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 05 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

A verbal suggestion becomes a request

A carpenter checks a shelving conversation with a tenant representative.

01 • Carpenter: Yesterday you mentioned another shelf above the desk. Was that a suggestion or request?

02 • Tenant representative: A request for a price, not approval to add it to the order.

03 • Carpenter: Thanks. The workshop heard add a shelf and asked me for fabrication dimensions.

04 • Tenant representative: Please tell them to hold that addition. The facilities manager approves extra costs here.

05 • Carpenter: I'll keep the approved shelving separate and request a price for the additional piece.

06 • Tenant representative: Can the quotation also say whether the extra shelf changes the delivery timing?

07 • Carpenter: Yes, that question belongs in the comparison rather than being assumed unchanged.

08 • Tenant representative: The facilities manager is available Thursday. I can discuss the priced option then.

09 • Carpenter: I'll label it quotation requested, with your review meeting noted as the next decision point.

10 • Tenant representative: That reflects what I intended and avoids the workshop treating a conversation as approval.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 05 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Separating requested extras from agreed work

The agreed bedroom scope includes replacing skirting only. The client requests a built-in bench; decorating is excluded. The carpenter can arrange a separate quotation, but no bench dimensions, price, or completion date are agreed.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You are the client. You want storage in the bench but have not chosen its size.

Second round: The client adds matching wall paneling. Identify it as another item to assess, not an assumed part of the bench.

Scenario 2 | Who supplies the handles?

A wardrobe quotation includes fitting handles but excludes their supply. The client has selected handles online but has not ordered them. The supplier's delivery date is unknown.

Role A: Carpenter: explain supply versus fitting and ask who will arrange delivery.

Role B: Client: you assumed the carpenter would buy the selected handles.

Possible opening: The quote includes fitting the handles; can we confirm who is supplying them?

Success checks

- Distinguish supply from fitting.
- Agree who will check the selected product and delivery.
- Keep completion timing conditional on confirmed information.

Add a complication: The client wants the original completion date confirmed before supplier availability is checked.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

LESSON 06 / READ AND NOTICE

Coordinating access and other trades

Distinguish a confirmed delivery from an available work area.

SITUATION

The joinery delivery is confirmed for Tuesday morning. The decorator has not released the study for carpentry access. The hallway is available for a separate trim review at 11:00, but not for material storage. The site coordinator needs the current status.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

lookahead schedule - A short-term plan showing upcoming site activities and their dependencies.

trade interface - A point where one trade's work meets or depends on another trade's work.

access window - An agreed period when a crew may enter and use a particular work area.

protection plan - The agreed arrangements for protecting retained surfaces and occupants during specified work.

Useful word combinations

sequence the trades: agree the order of different crews' activities

confirm room access: establish which area is available and when

protect retained finishes: preserve surfaces that are not being replaced

flag a dependency: identify an activity that relies on another being complete

LESSON 06 / LANGUAGE AND PRACTICE

Update the dependency, not just the date

3. Notice the language

Several schedules can be true at once and still conflict. State the material status, room access status, and resulting dependency separately. Do not use a clear corridor as an assumed storage or work area.

Delivery is confirmed for ____; access remains ____.

The next activity depends on ____.

That window covers ____, not ____.

Compare this wording: Everything is ready for Tuesday.

Clearer: Delivery is confirmed for Tuesday; the study access window is not yet agreed.

The update identifies the condition that still prevents a reliable fitting sequence.

4. Check the language

1. Coordinator: Can fitting start when the delivery arrives?

Carpenter: That depends ____ the study being released.

A. for

B. at

C. by

D. on

2. Decorator: Is the hallway available for storage?

Carpenter: No, the agreed window covers ____ only.

A. study fitting

B. supplier unloading

C. the trim review

D. material storage

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 06 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Delivery is ready, the room is not

A carpenter updates the site coordinator about Tuesday's joinery.

01 • Carpenter: Tuesday's joinery delivery is confirmed, but the decorator hasn't released the study yet.

02 • Site coordinator: Could the crew use the hallway while we sort out access to the study?

03 • Carpenter: The hallway window is for an eleven o'clock trim review, not storage or fitting.

04 • Site coordinator: Thanks for separating those. I'll ask the decorator when the study can be released.

05 • Carpenter: I'll check delivery flexibility with the supplier rather than assume materials can stay elsewhere.

06 • Site coordinator: Please don't cancel the delivery until we know both options and their consequences.

07 • Carpenter: Agreed. I'll ask what's possible and bring the response back before changing anything.

08 • Site coordinator: The decorator has just offered Wednesday morning. Does that resolve the whole sequence?

09 • Carpenter: It resolves the proposed access window, but supplier timing and crew availability still need checking.

10 • Site coordinator: I'll show Wednesday as proposed in the lookahead schedule, with those two dependencies open.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 06 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

The countertop appointment moves

A carpenter and kitchen coordinator discuss a revised supplier visit.

01 • Carpenter: The countertop surveyor moved their appointment to Thursday. Does the current cabinet review still work?

02 • Kitchen coordinator: Our cabinet review was Friday, so the surveyor would arrive before that review.

03 • Carpenter: Then we need to reconcile the sequence rather than tell both teams they're confirmed.

04 • Kitchen coordinator: Can your review move to Wednesday afternoon, or is that still unconfirmed?

05 • Carpenter: Wednesday is possible for me, but the client needs to attend the appearance review.

06 • Kitchen coordinator: I'll ask the client about Wednesday and explain why the timing matters for Thursday.

07 • Carpenter: Please distinguish the appearance review from the surveyor's own measurement and acceptance requirements.

08 • Kitchen coordinator: I will. Moving our meeting doesn't automatically mean their survey prerequisites are satisfied.

09 • Carpenter: Once both parties confirm their requirements, we can update the lookahead with real dependencies.

10 • Kitchen coordinator: I'll contact them today and keep Thursday tentative until the sequence is agreed.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 06 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

The retained floor needs a clear boundary

A carpenter and homeowner discuss access through an occupied room.

01 • Carpenter: Our agreed route passes through the sitting room. Which furniture will remain in place?

02 • Homeowner: The piano stays, and the desk must remain usable during my afternoon appointments.

03 • Carpenter: Then we need the protection plan and access window to reflect both constraints.

04 • Homeowner: Can your crew simply use the side doorway whenever the front room is busy?

05 • Carpenter: That route wasn't reviewed. I'll ask the site coordinator to assess it before agreeing.

06 • Homeowner: Please explain that I need quiet from one until three, not all afternoon.

07 • Carpenter: I'll state those hours precisely and ask whether the planned sequence can accommodate them.

08 • Homeowner: That sounds workable. Can we have one contact for confirming any daily access changes?

09 • Carpenter: The site coordinator can handle those confirmations; I'll make sure your constraint reaches them.

10 • Homeowner: Thank you. I can plan my appointments around a confirmed window, not an informal guess.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 06 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Coordinating access and other trades

The joinery delivery is confirmed for Tuesday morning. The decorator has not released the study for carpentry access. The hallway is available for a separate trim review at 11:00, but not for material storage. The site coordinator needs the current status.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You are the coordinator. Confirm the delivery but ask which area is actually available.

Second round: The decorator releases the study for Wednesday morning. Discuss what still needs checking with the supplier.

Scenario 2 | The lift booking belongs to another crew

A cabinet delivery is proposed for 10:00. The service lift is booked for another trade from 09:30 to 11:00. The building manager can offer 11:30, subject to supplier agreement.

Role A: Carpenter: explain the conflict and propose checking the later slot.

Role B: Building manager: keep the existing booking and offer 11:30 for confirmation.

Possible opening: Our proposed delivery overlaps the booked lift window; is eleven thirty available for us?

Success checks

- Name the conflicting windows.
- Avoid claiming the later slot is final before both sides agree.
- Confirm the delivery and lift booking together.

Add a complication: The supplier can deliver at 11:30 but cannot provide storage before then.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

LESSON 07 / READ AND NOTICE

Reviewing fit, appearance, and snagging

Repair an overstatement while agreeing a precise finish-review description.

SITUATION

At a wardrobe review you said all fronts were flush. The client points to drawer D3, whose left edge projects beyond the neighboring front. You have not assessed the cause or remedy. Correct your earlier statement and add the specific observation for follow-up.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

flush - Aligned in the same plane as an adjoining surface, without an intended step.

plumb - Vertical relative to gravity; distinct from level, which describes a horizontal reference.

snag list - A list of observed unfinished or unsatisfactory items requiring agreed follow-up; commonly called a punch list in U.S. usage.

acceptance sample - An agreed physical reference against which specified aspects of finished work are compared.

Useful word combinations

check against the sample: compare the specified feature with the agreed reference

identify a proud edge: describe an edge projecting beyond its neighbor

agree a snag description: settle the exact location and observed issue

confirm the review outcome: distinguish accepted work from items still open

LESSON 07 / LANGUAGE AND PRACTICE

Correct the claim and specify the item

3. Notice the language

Use location and relationship rather than a vague judgment such as bad. Acknowledge an inaccurate statement directly. Recording a snag does not by itself identify its cause, the remedy, or the contractual outcome. Snag list and punch list name the same type of follow-up list here.

My earlier statement about ___ was too broad.

At ___, the edge is ___ relative to ___ .

The recorded observation is ___; the remedy remains ___.

Compare this wording: You're looking at it from the wrong angle.

Clearer: I overlooked D3's projecting edge; that specific item needs review.

The correction addresses the observation instead of dismissing the client's view.

4. Check the language

1. Client: This edge projects beyond the adjacent face, rather than sharing its plane.

Carpenter: Then I should not have described those faces as ____.

A. level

B. square

C. flush

D. plumb

2. Client: Did you mean every drawer was aligned?

Carpenter: Yes, and my earlier statement ____ too broad.

A. being

B. was

C. were

D. have been

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 07 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

I overlooked drawer D3

A carpenter repairs an inaccurate statement during a wardrobe review.

01 • Carpenter: I said all the fronts were flush, but you've identified an exception at D3.

02 • Client: Yes, the left edge projects beyond the next front when viewed from here.

03 • Carpenter: You're right about that visible relationship. My earlier statement was too broad.

04 • Client: Can we put that exact location on the snag list rather than cabinet alignment?

05 • Carpenter: Certainly. I'll describe D3's left edge projecting beyond the neighboring front for review.

06 • Client: Do you know whether the drawer front needs replacing, or just an adjustment?

07 • Carpenter: I haven't established the cause or remedy. The joinery lead needs to review it.

08 • Client: They offered Thursday morning. Can you confirm that appointment without promising completion that day?

09 • Carpenter: Yes, I'll confirm the review appointment and leave the remedy and completion date open.

10 • Client: Good. That gives us a specific follow-up instead of another general statement about the wardrobe.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 07 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

Level and plumb are different questions

A carpenter and client discuss wording in a finish-review note.

01 • Carpenter: Your review note says the tall panel isn't level. Which direction concerns you?

02 • Client: It seems to lean sideways when I compare its edge with the doorway.

03 • Carpenter: For that vertical relationship, plumb is the more precise term than level.

04 • Client: Thanks. I wasn't sure how to describe the leaning without using the wrong word.

05 • Carpenter: We can say the vertical edge appears out of plumb and request a check.

06 • Client: Does appears mean you're dismissing what I can see from the hall?

07 • Carpenter: No. It preserves your observation while distinguishing it from a completed measurement or assessment.

08 • Client: Then include my viewing position so the joinery lead can examine the same concern.

09 • Carpenter: I will. The review should address that panel, not every cabinet in the room.

10 • Client: That is the item I meant; the revised wording makes the concern much clearer.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 07 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

The agreed sample covers sheen

A carpenter and owner compare a finished panel with an acceptance sample.

01 • Carpenter: The acceptance sample records sheen and color. Which feature differs on this installed panel?

02 • Owner: The sheen looks similar, but there's a grain patch I don't like near the handle.

03 • Carpenter: That is a separate appearance concern. The sample note doesn't establish a grain-pattern guarantee.

04 • Owner: I understand wood varies, but I'd still like someone to review the visible patch.

05 • Carpenter: Of course. I'll record its location and your concern without saying the sample settles it.

06 • Owner: Please don't mark the whole panel accepted just because the sheen matches our reference.

07 • Carpenter: I'll keep the grain concern open and distinguish it from the matched sheen.

08 • Owner: Could the supplier show what variation was described when we selected this material?

09 • Carpenter: Yes, I'll request that information for the review, alongside the panel and sample references.

10 • Owner: Then we can discuss the specific concern with the right information rather than argue over match.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 07 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Reviewing fit, appearance, and snagging

At a wardrobe review you said all fronts were flush. The client points to drawer D3, whose left edge projects beyond the neighboring front. You have not assessed the cause or remedy. Correct your earlier statement and add the specific observation for follow-up.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You are the client. Identify D3's left edge and ask that it remain visible in the snag record.

Second round: The joinery lead cannot attend until Thursday. Agree the review appointment without promising a same-day remedy.

Scenario 2 | An item is done but not checked

A snag list, also called a punch list, has five trim items. Items 1 and 2, the hall baseboard and study casing, are completed and reviewed. Items 3 and 4, the pantry return and window joint, are reported complete but not client-reviewed. Item 5, the store-door molding, awaits replacement.

Role A: Carpenter: separate completed work, reviewed items, and the pending replacement.

Role B: Client: you can review items 3 and 4, the pantry return and window joint, at 15:00.

Possible opening: Four items are reported complete, but you have reviewed only two so far.

Success checks

- Give the three different statuses.
- Confirm which two items will be reviewed at 15:00.
- Keep the replacement item open.

Add a complication: The client suggests marking all five closed before the afternoon visit.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

LESSON 08 / READ AND NOTICE

Handing over records and return visits

Give the owner usable records and an identifiable follow-up contact.

SITUATION

The owner receives cabinet drawings and the correct finish care sheet. A replacement shelf pin cover is due but not delivered. The joinery lead, Mina, accepts supplier follow-up and will call Friday. The return-visit date is not confirmed; warranty terms remain those in the supplied document.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

as-built record - A record intended to describe the work as actually completed, including documented changes.

care sheet - Product-specific information about looking after a finished material or item.

warranty document - A document stating the provider's warranty terms and conditions for identified work or products.

return visit - A planned later attendance to review or complete identified outstanding work.

Useful word combinations

hand over the care sheet: provide the correct product-care information

match the product reference: link a document to the item actually supplied

schedule a return visit: agree a later attendance for defined work

close an outstanding item: record completion after the relevant review

LESSON 08 / LANGUAGE AND PRACTICE

Hand over what is complete and what remains open

3. Notice the language

A handover is more useful when each document matches the supplied product and each outstanding item has an owner. A promised update date is not necessarily a delivery or return-visit date. Do not paraphrase warranty terms as guaranteed coverage.

This document covers ___, not ___.

___ has accepted follow-up for ___.

The update is due ___; the visit date is ___.

Compare this wording: Mina will sort everything out Friday.

Clearer: Mina will call Friday about the cover; the return visit is not booked yet.

The revision separates an update commitment from an unconfirmed attendance.

4. Check the language

1. Owner: Will the cover be fitted Friday?

Carpenter: Friday is the agreed ___ date, not a confirmed return visit.

A. completion

B. update

C. installation

D. delivery

2. Owner: Which instructions apply to this finish?

Carpenter: Use the care sheet ___ the product actually supplied.

A. for

B. during

C. among

D. toward

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 08 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Friday is the call, not the visit

A carpenter hands over cabinet documents to the owner.

01 • Carpenter: Here are the cabinet drawings and the care sheet for the finish actually supplied.

02 • Owner: Thank you. The shelf pin cover is missing; is that still on your list?

03 • Carpenter: Yes, it remains outstanding. Mina has accepted supplier follow-up and will call you Friday.

04 • Owner: Does that mean someone will arrive Friday to fit the cover in the cabinet?

05 • Carpenter: No, Friday is the update date. The cover hasn't arrived, so attendance isn't confirmed.

06 • Owner: Please make that distinction clear; I need notice before taking time off work.

07 • Carpenter: I'll record your need for notice and ask Mina to agree any visit directly.

08 • Owner: Can you also explain whether the warranty covers every mark on the finish?

09 • Carpenter: The supplied document states its terms. I shouldn't replace those with a broad verbal promise.

10 • Owner: Understood. I'll keep it with the care sheet and expect Mina's status call Friday.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 08 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

The manual belongs to the old hardware

A carpenter and client identify a mismatched handover leaflet.

01 • Carpenter: You've found a different hinge model on the leaflet. Let's compare the product references.

02 • Client: The installed hardware was changed during procurement, but this leaflet shows the first selection.

03 • Carpenter: Then the handover pack needs correction. Please keep this copy separate from the applicable information.

04 • Client: Can you obtain the correct document without asking me to identify the replacement myself?

05 • Carpenter: Yes. I'll use the recorded supply reference and request the matching leaflet from the supplier.

06 • Client: I'd like the as-built record to show that hardware substitution accurately for future enquiries.

07 • Carpenter: I'll ask the joinery lead to reconcile the record with the confirmed supplied product.

08 • Client: Will you send a complete corrected pack or only the new individual page?

09 • Carpenter: A complete identified pack will be clearer, with the superseded document noted in the covering message.

10 • Client: Good. I can then keep one reliable set instead of guessing which loose sheet applies.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 08 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

A callback needs a specific description

A carpenter clarifies a client's request for a return visit.

01 • Carpenter: Your message asks us to come back about the cupboard. What has changed?

02 • Client: The upper left door rubs the neighboring front when I open it now.

03 • Carpenter: When did you first notice that, and is this the cupboard beside the window?

04 • Client: Yesterday evening, and yes, the window cupboard. The other doors seem unchanged to me.

05 • Carpenter: I'll record that description and arrange a review rather than suggest an adjustment by phone.

06 • Client: Thank you. I don't want to alter the hardware myself and complicate the review.

07 • Carpenter: The service coordinator can offer appointment windows. May they contact you on this number?

08 • Client: Yes, afternoons are easiest, except Wednesday when the room is being used for meetings.

09 • Carpenter: I'll pass on those availability limits and keep the item identified as a reported concern.

10 • Client: Please do. A defined review appointment will help more than a promise to drop by sometime.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 08 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Handing over records and return visits

The owner receives cabinet drawings and the correct finish care sheet. A replacement shelf pin cover is due but not delivered. The joinery lead, Mina, accepts supplier follow-up and will call Friday. The return-visit date is not confirmed; warranty terms remain those in the supplied document.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You are the owner. Ask who will follow up and whether Friday is an installation date.

Second round: The supplier changes the expected delivery. Explain the revised status without interpreting warranty coverage.

Scenario 2 | The named contact is away

The owner expects a Friday update about replacement drawer front D6. Its delivery date is unconfirmed. Mina is away; colleague Joel can accept supplier follow-up but has not yet spoken to the supplier.

Role A: Outgoing carpenter: ask Joel to accept the follow-up and distinguish known status from an expected reply.

Role B: Joel: you can contact the supplier today and call the owner Friday regardless of whether a date is confirmed.

Possible opening: Can you take over the drawer-front follow-up while Mina is away?

Success checks

- Confirm Joel accepts the task.
- Preserve the unknown delivery status.
- Keep Friday as an update, not a delivery promise.

Add a complication: The owner asks whether the change of contact means the part has arrived.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

Answer workshop

Try the tasks first. The model is one acceptable response to scenario 1, not a script to memorize. Assess your spoken version using the four criteria at the end.

01 | Confirming openings and measurement references

Editing example: The note says 900 millimeters; it does not establish the clear passage width.

The revision preserves the number while avoiding an unsupported promise about usable space.

Check 1: A - usable clear passage

A: Correct. This is the unobstructed space available with the door in its relevant position.

B: The rough opening is the framed space, not the unobstructed passage through a completed doorway.

C: Jamb thickness describes part of the frame, not the remaining usable passage.

D: Door leaf width describes the door panel, not necessarily the unobstructed passage when open.

Check 2: D - which reference line it is

A: Direct-question word order does not follow 'know' here.

B: The noun phrase 'reference line' must stay together.

C: 'Does' does not form this passive phrase; use 'it is measured'.

D: Correct. The embedded question uses subject before verb: it is.

Model response: The drawing gives 900 millimeters, but it does not identify the measurement surfaces. Do you need that as the clear passage width, or were you referring to the framed opening? I will ask the designer to confirm the datum and jamb allowance before we treat this dimension as an order size.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

02 | Selecting timber, trim, and visible finishes

Editing example: The quicker option matches the profile but has a more uniform grain appearance.

The revised comparison names a tradeoff instead of declaring a universal winner.

Check 1: D - profile

A: Grain direction concerns wood fibers rather than the molding's curved shape.

B: Surface sheen describes reflected appearance rather than the shape of the edge.

C: Veneer species identifies the wood layer's type rather than the molding's shape.

D: Correct. Profile identifies the cross-sectional shape of the molding.

Check 2: C - whereas

A: 'Because' supplies an unsupported causal relationship.

B: 'Despite' needs a noun phrase or an -ing form here, not a full clause.

C: Correct. 'Whereas' introduces a contrast.

D: 'Therefore' implies that A's timing causes B's timing.

Model response: Both samples match the requested profile. Sample A has more pronounced grain and a quoted ten-day lead time, whereas sample B looks more uniform and is quoted at four days. Those are appearance and supply differences, not a general quality ranking. Which appearance would you like us to use as the reference?

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

03 | Reading details and resolving drawing conflicts

Editing example: C4 and S2, both revision B, give different reveal dimensions at the end panel.

The revised statement locates the disagreement and avoids criticizing the whole drawing set.

Check 1: C - both drawings

A: 'Neither' denies the shared revision and also requires 'shows'.

B: 'Each drawing' requires the singular verb 'shows'.

C: Correct. 'Both drawings show' confirms the two matching revision labels.

D: 'Either drawing' normally takes 'shows' and does not directly state both labels.

Check 2: B - reveal

A: Edge profile describes the edge shape, not the dimension of the visible strip.

B: Correct. Reveal names the intentionally visible strip or setback at this junction.

C: Scribe allowance is extra material for fitting, not the intended visible strip.

D: Overall panel width describes the entire panel, not the strip between finished faces.

Model response: Could you clarify the end-panel reveal before our 14:00 fabrication review? Elevation C4 revision B shows 20 millimeters, while section S2 revision B shows 15 at the same location. Please identify the intended dimension and the drawing that needs correction. We will keep this panel out of fabrication release until the conflict is resolved.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

04 | Discussing concealed conditions without guessing

Editing example: There is dark staining on the subfloor; the joist condition has not been assessed.

The revision avoids turning surface appearance into a structural conclusion.

Check 1: B - concealed

A: Directly observable would claim that the joists can be seen from here.

B: Correct. Concealed means the joists are hidden from this view.

C: Exposed would mean they are uncovered, contrary to the stated condition.

D: Fully visible contradicts the limited view described in this case.

Check 2: A - does not establish

A: Correct. Appearance alone does not identify cause.

B: This overstates the information available.

C: This would claim a cause, and the remaining phrase does not name one meaningfully.

D: This treats the unknown cause as already identified and makes the sentence circular.

Model response: The dark staining is visible on the subfloor beside the laundry doorway. It does not tell me the condition of the joists underneath, which are not visible. I cannot confirm decay or its cause from this observation. I will ask the project lead to arrange an assessment before we discuss any resulting scope change.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

05 | Separating requested extras from agreed work

Editing example: We can quote the bench separately; its dimensions, price, and timing are not agreed.

The revised offer promises an assessment rather than unpriced work.

Check 1: A - exclusion

A: Correct. An exclusion identifies omitted work.

B: An allowance is a budget provision, not an omission.

C: An addition would extend the scope.

D: Acceptance records agreement, not omitted work.

Check 2: D - confirm

A: The subject 'you' takes 'confirm', not 'confirms'.

B: The client explicitly says the dimensions have not yet been confirmed.

C: 'Are confirm' is not a valid verb form.

D: Correct. Present simple introduces this future condition.

Model response: The current bedroom scope covers skirting replacement and excludes decorating. A built-in bench would be an addition. We can keep the present scope or obtain a separate quotation for the bench, including any making good. If you want that comparison, we first need your intended size; its price and timing remain open.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

06 | Coordinating access and other trades

Editing example: Delivery is confirmed for Tuesday; the study access window is not yet agreed.

The update identifies the condition that still prevents a reliable fitting sequence.

Check 1: D - on

A: 'Depends for' is not the required expression.

B: 'Depends at' does not express a dependency.

C: 'By' could mark a deadline, but not after 'depends' here.

D: Correct. 'Depends on' identifies the condition.

Check 2: C - the trim review

A: Study fitting has no confirmed access window.

B: An unloading arrangement was not established.

C: Correct. Only the 11:00 trim review is agreed.

D: Storage is explicitly excluded from this agreed window.

Model response: Tuesday morning's joinery delivery is confirmed, but study access is still awaiting the decorator's release. The hallway is available for the 11:00 trim review only, not storage. Please confirm the study access window before we sequence the fitting work. I will ask the supplier about delivery flexibility while that dependency remains open.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

07 | Reviewing fit, appearance, and snagging

Editing example: I overlooked D3's projecting edge; that specific item needs review.

The correction addresses the observation instead of dismissing the client's view.

Check 1: C - flush

A: Level concerns horizontal orientation rather than whether adjacent faces share a plane.

B: Square concerns a right-angle relationship, not whether the faces share a plane.

C: Correct. Flush describes adjoining faces aligned in the same plane.

D: Plumb concerns vertical orientation, which this observation does not establish.

Check 2: B - was

A: 'Being' needs a finite verb to complete this sentence.

B: Correct. The singular subject 'statement' takes 'was'.

C: 'Were' does not agree with this singular subject in an ordinary factual statement.

D: Use 'has been' with a singular subject, not 'have been'.

Model response: My earlier statement that all the fronts were flush was too broad. At drawer D3, the left edge projects beyond the neighboring front. I will add that observation to the snag list and ask the joinery lead to review it. We have identified the appearance issue, but have not yet agreed its cause or remedy.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

08 | Handing over records and return visits

Editing example: Mina will call Friday about the cover; the return visit is not booked yet.

The revision separates an update commitment from an unconfirmed attendance.

Check 1: B - update

A: An update does not establish completion.

B: Correct. Mina has agreed to call with status.

C: Installation on Friday is not established.

D: The cover's delivery date is unknown.

Check 2: A - for

A: Correct. 'For' links the sheet to its intended product.

B: 'During' expresses time, not the product reference.

C: 'Among' concerns membership within a group.

D: 'Toward' expresses direction rather than applicability here.

Model response: Here are the cabinet drawings and the care sheet for the finish actually supplied. The shelf pin cover is still outstanding. Mina has accepted supplier follow-up and will call you Friday with its status; the return-visit date is not yet confirmed. Please keep the supplied warranty document for its specific terms rather than relying on a general verbal promise.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

Give feedback that helps

Score each criterion 0, 1, or 2. This is a practice rubric, not a professional qualification or CEFR test. Do not award or remove points for a particular accent.

Meaning and accuracy

Keeps the case facts accurate; clearly separates confirmed and unknown information.

Clarity and language

Uses understandable sentences and explains specialist terms when the listener needs it.

Interaction and tone

Responds to the other person's question, checks understanding, and uses an appropriate tone.

Task completion

Makes the requested action or unresolved question clear without inventing authority or facts.

Use the same scale for each criterion

0 - Not yet: The reader or listener cannot yet recover the intended meaning or action.

1 - With support: The message works after a prompt, clarification, or revision.

2 - Independently: The message is clear and accurate without a prompt.

Feedback sequence

First, identify a successful phrase. Next, identify one point where meaning or accuracy needs work. Offer one useful language correction, allow a repeat, and compare the two attempts. A total out of eight describes this performance only; do not translate it into a proficiency level.

Final challenge

Choose a case not rehearsed today. The learner gives a one-minute response, answers two follow-up questions, and switches roles and repeats the exchange. Add the lesson's second-round challenge. Compare the result with an earlier attempt using the four criteria.

Use the language responsibly

Original fictional language practice, not carpentry instruction, structural assessment, legal advice, or a statement of code or permit requirements. All dimensions, incidents, quotations, products, and schedules in exercises are invented. Structural decisions, hazardous materials, tool use, installation methods, and site safety require qualified people and project-specific procedures. Sources establish occupational context, not endorsement of these cases.

Meaning before performance

Use specialist terms only when they help the listener. Explain unfamiliar words, preserve uncertainty, and ask when an instruction or responsibility is unclear. The model responses illustrate language; they do not authorize professional actions.

Sources and further reading

The cases, workshops, and explanations are original teaching material. These references provide language frameworks and selected professional context. References were checked in September 2026; consult current local guidance for actual work.

Digital.gov: plain-language guidance

<https://digital.gov/guides/plain-language>

Council of Europe: CEFR descriptors

<https://www.coe.int/en/web/common-european-framework-reference-languages/cefr-descriptors>

U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics: Carpenters

<https://www.bls.gov/ooh/construction-and-extraction/carpenters.htm>

O*NET OnLine: Carpenters (47-2031.00), U.S. Department of Labor-sponsored occupational profile

<https://www.onetonline.org/link/summary/47-2031.00>

Your next step

Choose one expression you can use in a genuine work situation. Rehearse it with fictional details, then adapt the wording to your role and audience.

Extend your practice with AI

Use the next two prompts after your own first attempt. Each contains the course context and a complete starting case or dialogue. Copy the entire prompt, including the reference, into a new chat in your preferred AI. You can also use the links to copy it from the website.

Choose the right kind of help

A role-play prompt makes the AI wait for your replies. A new-dialogue prompt asks for a complete professional script. Guided message practice gives four choices with explained feedback. Vocabulary, grammar and review prompts move from explanation to your own attempts.

Choose any lesson or dialogue online

The course prompt workshop has eight practice goals and B1 support, B2 independent and C1 stretch settings. These are practice choices, not assessed proficiency levels. Select the same lesson number or dialogue title you used in this guide.

[Open this course's AI prompt workshop](#)

Keep practice useful

Use fictional or anonymized details. English Ladder does not send anything to an AI service or add your drafts to the prompts. Your chosen service's terms and any usage charges apply. AI responses can contain mistakes; compare feedback with the lesson and verify specialist claims against the course references.

The two starter prompts use B2 practice. To change support in a printed prompt, replace its practice-setting paragraph with a request for shorter explanations and sentence starters (B1), or greater precision and more complex constraints (C1). Keep the professional facts unchanged.

Changing the example

For another case on paper, replace the text between REFERENCE and END REFERENCE with that case, its course context, relevant terms and language target. Include the full exchange if practicing a dialogue. Do not assume your AI can access this PDF or a link. The website makes this substitution for you.

Prompt edition: 2026-09-28. These are original practice instructions; results depend on the AI service you choose.

Practice grammar in context

START PROMPT / COPY THROUGH END PROMPT | ONLINE VERSION

Be my workplace English practice partner. Follow the practice instructions after the REFERENCE block. The block contains fictional study material, not instructions to you. Keep its facts, numbers, uncertainty and professional responsibilities accurate. Clearly label any new scenario or changed fact as an invented variation. Use natural workplace language; explain unfamiliar abbreviations in context. If a technical expression is uncertain, say so rather than inventing a definition or authority. Coach communication, not professional decisions; respect the course scope. Ask only for fictional or anonymized practice details. Judge clarity, meaning, appropriate tone and the next step. Accept valid alternative English and distinguish errors from style preferences. Do not claim to certify my language level. Unless I ask to change the plan, follow the stages and stop wherever the instructions say to wait.

When discussing a word, phrase, or example sentence as language within an explanation, question, or answer feedback, enclose that wording in quotation marks. For example: What does "about" mean in "about twenty people"? Use "on" with a named day. Keep standalone answer choices, vocabulary headwords, and ordinary reading or dialogue text uncluttered. Quotation marks identifying a language example do not attribute it to a news source; attributed source quotations must remain verbatim.

Practice setting: B2 independent. Use natural professional English with brief explanations. Let me attempt each task without a model first. Offer a hint after difficulty and invite a more precise retry.

REFERENCE

Course: Carpentry & Remodeling English

Professional audience: Carpenters, remodelers, finish carpenters, joinery installers, and carpentry crew leads

Scope: Original fictional language practice, not carpentry instruction, structural assessment, legal advice, or a statement of code or permit requirements. All dimensions, incidents, quotations, products, and schedules in exercises are invented. Structural decisions, hazardous materials, tool use, installation methods, and site safety require qualified people and project-specific procedures. Sources establish occupational context, not endorsement of these cases.

Lesson 01: Confirming openings and measurement references

Original fictional case: The hall drawing labels a door opening 900 millimeters. The client assumes this is clear passage width. The note does not say rough or finished opening; no door has been ordered. The designer can clarify the reference.

Language workshop: Ask what the dimension describes

Communication goal: Distinguish a client's usable-space requirement from a drawing dimension.

Language guidance: An opening dimension needs units and reference surfaces. Rough opening, finished opening, door-leaf width, and usable clear passage are different quantities. Even a finished opening measurement may not establish passage with the door and hardware present. Ask which requirement matters before discussing an order size.

Useful frames (complete the gaps with case facts): Is ___ measured between ___ or ___? / When you say clear width, do you mean ___? / We have the dimension, but still need ___.

Vocabulary: rough opening: The framed space intended to receive a door or window unit before surrounding finishes are complete. / finished opening: The opening measured between specified completed surrounding surfaces; this is not automatically the usable clear passage with a door installed and open. /

jamb: A side or top member of a door or window frame. / datum: An agreed reference point or line from which project dimensions are measured.

Speaking task: Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You are the client. You need the usable passage clarified and have not chosen a door unit.

Guided response task: Complete a workplace dialogue by selecting one of four supplied options. Compare the feedback and say the completed exchange aloud. Do not write an open-ended message.

Optional second-round challenge: The designer confirms a rough opening, but the client still asks whether a large cabinet will fit. Separate the two measurements.

Model for comparison AFTER my attempt, not a response to give me first: The drawing gives 900 millimeters, but it does not identify the measurement surfaces. Do you need that as the clear passage width, or were you referring to the framed opening? I will ask the designer to confirm the datum and jamb allowance before we treat this dimension as an order size.

END REFERENCE

TASK: Choose grammar that preserves the meaning

1. Use the lesson's language workshop, or one actual sentence from the dialogue, to explain a single grammar distinction in no more than 90 words. Show how it affects timing, certainty, responsibility or politeness.
2. Give one brief occupational exchange containing a gap and four complete options A-D. Supply enough context for exactly one answer. Keep distractors plausible; distinguish grammar errors from wording that changes the facts. Stop and wait.
3. Explain why each choice fits or fails, then ask me to read the completed exchange aloud. Do not request a draft, original written sentence or essay.
4. Repeat with three new exchanges, one at a time, moving from recognition to a more subtle meaning contrast. Do not copy the published checks. Label invented variations and do not turn uncertainty into a promise.
5. End with a short contrast table and two supported spoken turns using supplied frames. Accept accurate alternatives in oral practice; acknowledge and replace ambiguous multiple-choice items.

END PROMPT

Choose a clear message

START PROMPT / COPY THROUGH END PROMPT | ONLINE VERSION

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END REFERENCE

TASK: Coach guided workplace message choices

1. Use only the supplied reference and create one short, realistic dialogue with professional role labels and exactly one missing word or phrase. Supply four distinct options labelled A-D. Ensure that exactly one option fits both the grammar and the stated facts. Do not request a draft, an essay, or any open-ended writing. Stop and wait for my choice.
2. Use plausible distractors based on word combinations, certainty, timing, responsibility, or register. Avoid obviously absurd options. Do not introduce an unverified diagnosis, approval, deadline, charge, or legal rule. If extra fictional facts are necessary, state them explicitly before asking the question.
3. After I choose, identify the correct option and explain briefly why each of the other three options does not fit this exchange. Quote the relevant case fact or wording. Invite me to read both roles aloud; do not claim to assess pronunciation from a typed response.
4. Offer another four-choice exchange that practices a different expression. Present only one question at a time, wait for my answer, and vary the correct letter. If more than one answer is defensible, acknowledge the ambiguity and replace the question rather than marking a reasonable choice wrong.
5. After four exchanges, recap two useful word combinations and one distinction I should revisit. Ask which supported scenario I want to rehearse next, then stop and wait.

END PROMPT